and then break dollar hegemony, especially given the inevitability of rising Chinese yuan convertibility and the Moscow–Beijing (non-$) energy deal a few weeks before Fortaleza. But revealingly, both the New Development Bank (NDB) and 'Contingent Reserve Arrangement' (CRA) (VI BRICS Summit 2014b) have this feature: 'The Requesting Party's [borrower's] central bank shall sell the Requesting Party Currency to the Providing Parties' central banks and purchase US dollars from them by means of a spot transaction, with a simultaneous agreement by the Requesting Party's central bank to sell US dollars and to repurchase the Requesting Party Currency from the Providing Parties' central banks on the maturity date' (VI BRICS Summit 2014). That represents ongoing dollar addiction: a retox, not detox. The dollar is an inappropriate crutch in so many ways, but aside from University of London radical economist John Weeks (2014) writing on the eve of Fortaleza, few analysts acknowledge that genuinely 'inclusive sustainable development' finance would not require much US dollar (or any foreign currency-denominated) credits. Hard currency isn't needed if BRICS countries – or even future hinterland borrowers – want to address most of their vast infrastructure deficits in basic needs housing, school construction and teacher pay, water and sanitation piping, road building, agriculture support, and the like. The US dollar financing hints at huge import bills for future mega-project White Elephant infrastructure entailing multinational corporate technology (like most of South Africa's 2010 World Cup stadiums).

Who, then, will likely benefit? Weeks continues, 'The suspicion uppermost in my mind is that the purpose of the BRICS bank, as a project funding bank, is to link the finance offered to the construction firms and materials suppliers located in the BRICS themselves.' Certainly, the Chinese Government is notorious for doing this; a $5 billion loan from the China Development Bank to the South African transport parastatal Transnet announced at Durban's 2013 BRICS Summit resulted in $4.8 billion worth of locomotive orders from Chinese joint ventures a year later. As Weeks (2014) also observes, 'the voting proposal for the BRICS bank follows the IMF/World Bank model: money votes with shares, reflecting each government's financial contribution. The largest voting share goes to China, whose record on investments in Africa is nothing short of appalling … The warm endorsement of the NDB by the president of the World Bank suggests enthusiasm rather than tension.'

But isn't the CRA a $100 billion 'replacement' for the IMF, as was widely advertised? No, it *amplifies* IMF power. If a BRICS borrower wants access to the final 70% of its credit quota, the founding documents insist, that loan can only come contingent on 'evidence of the existence of an on-track arrangement